

A. Prior to building my wealth, I had gone through a series of mindset exercises to shift the way I viewed money and investing. Therefore, I already viewed money and wealth from an abundance perspective. This perspective on money and investing helped guide me through my wealth creation journey. I was laser-focused on my goals, as well as on why I was working so hard to achieve my goals. I found myself posting my goals in high-traffic locations throughout my home and my place of work. These gentle reminders worked to keep me motivated to accomplish my bold, audacious goals. That one simple act had such a transformational impact on my life, and served to shift my focus from being exclusively about money to being exclusively about economic options.

Q. Did you have any investing fears? How did you overcome them?

A. There was only one fear that I had as it relates to investing, and that was the fear of an investment advisor losing my money. Unfortunately, that fear came true during the 2008 financial crisis. I hired a financial advisor to manage \$125,000 of my husband's and my money, and the advisor proceeded to lose close to 75% of the money we entrusted him to manage. That experience strengthened my desire to learn everything I could about self-directed investing. Instead of allowing that experience to deter me from investing in the stock market, I decided to turn the situation around by taking full control of my investment portfolio. I have never looked back, and have been successfully managing my family's investments without the assistance of an advisor.

Q. Did you make any investing mistakes? And if so, how did you recover from them?

A. Absolutely! I think every investor makes investment mistakes at the beginning of their investing journey. One of the biggest mistakes I made was not doing thorough due diligence on a company prior to buying its stock. The fact that this mistake was made early in my journey is a saving grace. Had these same mistakes occurred more recently, it would have had a more lasting effect on my investment portfolio. The tip I have for any new investor is not to try to avoid mistakes, but instead do your best to learn from them.

Q. What is your current investment strategy?